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Changelog

- V0.05 - Sections VI, VII, VIII, IX
- V0.04 - Draft of Section V mechanics
- V0.03 - Section II and III Story and Characters and Section IV, input
- V0.02 - Filling out the Overview
- V0.01 - Outlining of Index and structure prediction of GDD

Overview

Concept

A replayable dungeon crawler focused on procedurally generated floors, randomized loot, and permanent progression through repeated expeditions.

Genre

Primary Genre - Action Adventure

Subgenres - 2d, Dungeon Crawler, Action RPG, Exploration, Roguelite

Platform

Unity deliverable platforms. Windows (Primary), Linux, Mac, Steam as possibilities.

Objective(s)

Explore the dungeon.

Defeat increasingly dangerous enemies

Collect loot and equipment

Acquire stronger abilities

Defeat bosses

Die and level up

Gameplay loop

Explore -> Fight -> Upgrade -> New Area Unlock -> Repeat

End Condition

Death ends the individual run, persistent upgrades remain.

Game focus on replayability with no ultimate end beyond player enjoyment

Target Audience

Age 13+, fans of binding of isaac, enter the guneon, dungeon of the endless, and guild of dungeoneering.

Story

Story will be minimal, primarily delivered through environmental story telling and ambiance. Maybe small bits of text as the game develops. The primary focus of the game is not a narrative one.

Characters

Player Character

The Player character will be a 2d sprite that navigates the procedural level generation.

Customization to character appearance is not a priority, the main interaction with the player character will be new items and abilities.

NPCs

NPCs will mainly take the form of hostile entities throughout the dungeon levels.

Enemies that deal and take damage as part of the combat section of the main gameplay loop. Their exact form is to be determined, and will likely come in several types.

Input and Interaction

Player input will be on the keyboard and mouse. Player movement should be controlled by W A S D keys, while aiming and menu navigation is a result of moving the mouse and clicking.

Mechanics

Procedural Level generation

Each level of the dungeon should be randomly generated from a set of tiles, each tile being a “room”. The various rooms will have connection points to allow them to connect to adjacent rooms, and every door should either lead to a new room, or exit the level. Doors can lead to dead end rooms, but a dead end should be a room with no exit doors, not a door with no connection.

Player Equipment

As the player explores and defeats enemies, there will be a chance to drop new equipment. Equipment will have mechanical bonuses like increased health, defense, damage, etc. and should fit into the slots

Head

Chest

Legs

Feat

L Hand

R Hand

Ring 1

Ring 2

Necklace

Limiting the amount of equipment a character can hold and forcing them to make choices.

Player Abilities

As the player defeats enemies and gains XP rather than “level up” in a traditional sense, they will unlock new abilities, either new abilities entirely, or upgrades to previously unlocked abilities.

Persistent Upgrades

Persistent upgrades at the end of each run will be retaining a % of increased stats, or choosing an item to spawn with in the next run. (limited to 1, including the one they started with if not the first run). At the end of the run they should also generate points towards an out of character shop with small passive boosts that apply to each run.

Increasing Difficulty

The longer the player plays the more enemies should be in each room, and each enemy can deal more damage and has higher health and defense.

Environments

The Game environment is based on a set of tiles. Depending on what assets are available, different levels could have different themes. Water, Lava, Jungle Ruin, Skeleton Dungeon, Sewer, ETC.

Dynamics

The hope is that with the core gameplay being focused around repetitive elements and incremental progress, dynamic approaches to gameplay will arise as the players try different methods and styles, finding their preferred approach.

Assets / Art

Visual assets should be sought out from the unity store and other third party providers, or made by hand. At this moment there are none in mind.

SFX

Sounds and Music should be sought out from the unity store and other third party providers, or made by hand. At this moment there are none in mind.